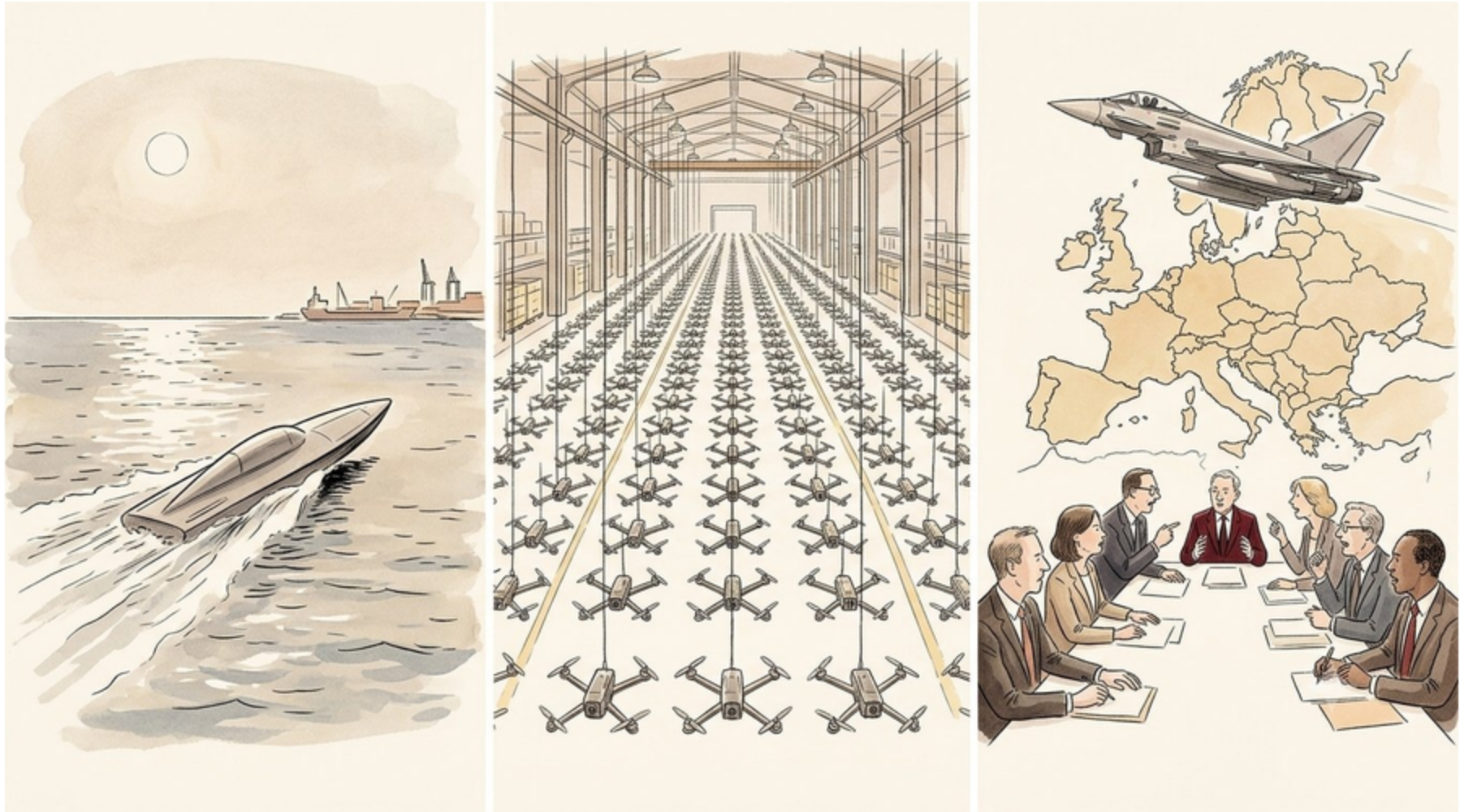


Defense Brief

July 14, 2026



US Sea Drones Make Combat Debut
Against Iran, Germany Buys 50,000
FPV Drones for Ukraine, UK Pours
£5.4B Into Typhoon Fleet

The Bottom Line

Three developments stood out on July 14: the US military's first-ever combat use of sea drones against Iran signals that unmanned naval warfare has moved from experimentation to operational strikes; Germany's €90M order for 50,000 AI-guided FPV drones for Ukraine shows mass autonomous munitions procurement becoming routine; and France's decision to license Ukraine to produce SCALP, Aster, and AASM missiles represents a shift from donating finished weapons to transferring production technology. Meanwhile, the UK chose fleet longevity over new Typhoon orders, Lockheed pressed ahead with an \$850M nuclear missile extension, and a Korea-US-Japan SMR pact opened a new front in the competition for nuclear export markets against China and Russia.